

the Sony VAIO even provided a dual-layer DVD-Writer.

Some laptops like the Fujitsu even featured fingerprint recognition. An external button to turn Wi-Fi off and on was also available in many of the laptops.

Usability

The Acer TravelMate 3002WTCi, Dell Latitude X1, Fujitsu LifeBook LBP7010 and Samsung Note PC Q30 Plus sported the sleekest form factors. The Fujitsu LBP7010 is still the winner in this aspect due to the fact that it has an integrated optical drive where the others have external drives.

The Dell Latitude and the Samsung Q30 Plus weighed the lowest at 1.14 kg each without the external drive. But when the carry weight was noted, the Fujitsu LBP7010 again weighed the lowest at 1.85 kg.

Ergonomics

The 'accessibility of ports' rating for all the laptops was almost the same because all the vendors have taken care to place the ports in an uncluttered manner.

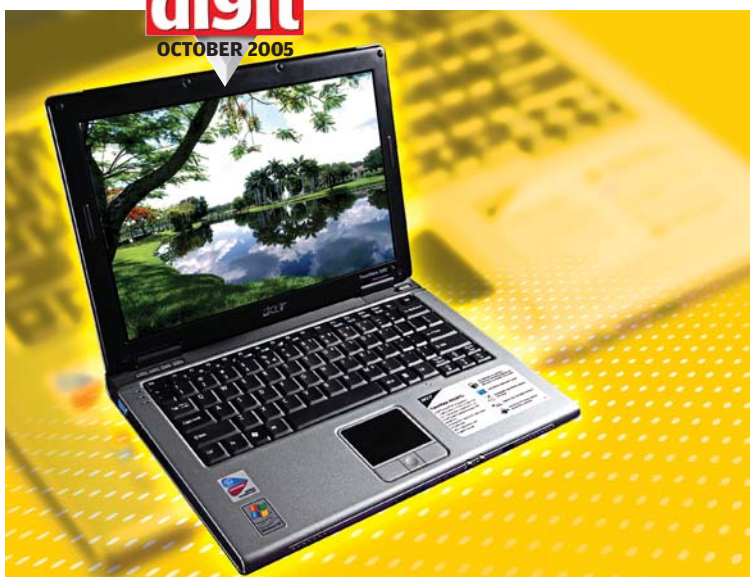
In the keyboard feel and touchpad sensitivity ratings, both Fujitsu laptops along with the Sony VAIO surged ahead of the rest, but the others were not far behind either. In overall ergonomics, the bigger laptops—namely the Fujitsu LBS6240 and the Sony VAIO—scored the highest. The smaller laptops could not score high because of the cramped keyboard and touchpad.

In the speaker quality test, too, the Fujitsu LBS6240 and Sony VAIO scored quite high.

Package Contents

Windows XP Professional SP2 came preinstalled on all the laptops except the MSI S270, which had Windows XP Home Edition with SP2. Similarly, a driver and recovery CD or DVD of some sort accompanied each laptop.

The Fujitsu laptops came with Norman Virus Control CDs, while the Sony VAIO, Acer and Samsung came with Norton AntiVirus 2005.



Fujitsu Lifebook LBS6240

DVD players such as PowerDVD and WinDVD came with almost all laptops, while Sony, MSI and Fujitsu gave additional multimedia software like PowerProducer and Adobe Premiere.

The Fujitsu and the MSI were the only laptops that came with a carry case. A couple of other accessories, such as a screen wiping cloth, were provided by Fujitsu.

The Acer, Dell and Samsung laptops also came with an extra battery pack.

Performance

ZD-Bench Business Winstone 2004

In the ZD-Bench Business Winstone 2004 test, the Sony VAIO topped the charts with a score of 20.5, which is a healthy score for any laptop.

Close behind was the Fujitsu LBS6240 with 19.1 and the Acer TravelMate with 19. The MSI MegaBook S260 scored the lowest at 13.3.

In the video encoding test too, the scores were not too different. Sony VAIO logged the lowest time of 183 seconds, followed by Acer at 184 seconds. The Samsung Q30 Plus was last, taking a whopping 454 seconds to encode our video!

SiSoft Sandra 2005

In the SiSoft Sandra 2005 CPU and memory benchmarks, once again, Sony VAIO and Acer were neck-and-neck, while the MSI S270 scored the lowest.

In the filesystem benchmark, Dell's Latitude and Samsung's Q30 Plus scored the lowest. The other laptops were all on par with each other.

Game test

In the game test, as was expected, the Sony VAIO, with the PCI-Express GeForce 6200 Go, rocketed ahead. In *Call of Duty* at 1024 x 768, the VAIO scored 101.7 fps, where none of the other laptops could breach the 30 fps limit.

Similarly, in *FarCry*, the VAIO scored 57.15 fps at 1024 x 768, while the others could not even score 15 fps!



Acer-Travelmate 3002WTCi